HACK876 × AISK

INFORMATION BOOKLET FOR THE PRINCIPAL

# An invitation for American International School of Kingston



**Build something that should exist.**

**DATE**
Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)

**HOURS**
8:00 AM to 7:30 PM

**VENUE**
Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston, Jamaica

**COST**
Free for schools and students

Hack 876 is a one-day build competition for Jamaican secondary-school students. In teams of 3 to 4, students choose a real problem, build a prototype that addresses it, and present it to a panel of judges.

**The AISK page**

**www.hack876.com/schools/aisk**

## Prepared for Dr. Christie Powell, Middle and High School Principal

Hack 876 is organized independently of American International School of Kingston. This booklet sets out what the day involves and what we would ask of the school.

WHY AISK

# AISK ALREADY BUILDS.

**AISK Hurricane, FIRST Tech Challenge team 17980, won the Inspire Award at the Jamaica championship in 2023–24 and has competed at the FIRST World Championship two seasons running.**

### Robotics

Inspire Award 2023–24, Innovate Award 2022–23, and the World Championship in 2023–24 and 2024–25.

### Team Jamaica

An AISK student on Jamaica's 2024 Robotics Olympics team, and AISK in the 2026 delegation.

### Clubs

A Coding Hub, a Drone Club, a STEM Club and Hurricane Hut, a student-run store.

### A laptop each

Students in Grades 5 to 12 bring their own MacBook daily, which suits a build-your-own-device event.

> **"Our students shape the future."**
>
> American International School of Kingston, vision · aisk.com

Hack 876 brings together students from across Kingston for one day: mixed teams, a fixed deadline, industry mentors and judges who ask teams to explain their decisions. It is a chance for AISK students to build alongside peers they would not otherwise meet.

### What students practise

- Defining a real problem
- Designing, building and testing a solution
- Teamwork with students from other schools
- Explaining their work to judges

These are among the skills assessed in CSEC Information Technology and in CAPE Computer Science and Digital Media. Hack 876 is independent of CXC and the Ministry, and taking part does not count toward any SBA.

THE DAY

# One day, from first idea to working demo.

A hackathon is an event where small teams build something from scratch in a single day, then present it to judges. No programming experience is needed: teams also need students who design, research, write and present. Mentors who work in industry help throughout the day.

**Many students will be at their first hackathon, and no coding experience is needed.**

**DATE** TENTATIVE
Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)

**VENUE** CONFIRMED
Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston

**HOURS**
8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. One day, not overnight.

**WHO**
Students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form (Grades 11 and 12 at AISK)

**SIZE**
About 80 students from several schools

**TEAMS**
3 to 4 students per team

## The full schedule

One day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. Not overnight.

**ARRIVE**

| | |
|---|---|
| **8:00 AM** | Doors open |
| **9:00 AM** | Opening |
| **9:20 AM** | Keynote |
| **9:35 AM** | Challenge reveal |

**BUILD**

| | |
|---|---|
| **9:45 AM** | Hacking begins |
| **12:00 PM** | Lunch |
| **3:00 PM** | Submissions open |
| **4:00 PM** | Hacking ends |

**SHOW**

| | |
|---|---|
| **4:15 PM** | Judging |
| **5:30 PM** | Finalists announced |
| **5:45 PM** | Finals |

**CELEBRATE**

| | |
|---|---|
| **6:45 PM** | Awards |
| **7:00 PM** | Photos + hangout |
| **7:30 PM** | That's a wrap |

WHAT STUDENTS BUILD

# Real problems, working prototypes.

Each team picks a track for inspiration, chooses a real problem within it, and builds a working prototype. The tracks guide ideas. They do not limit them.

**Learn**
Rethink how people learn.

**Everyday Jamaica**
Make daily life, getting around and staying well easier.

**Create & Hustle**
Build for small businesses, creators and Jamaican culture.

**Resilience**
Think climate, infrastructure, emergencies, or community resilience.

**Wildcard**
Build something nobody asked for.

**What teams can make**

Websites · Apps · AI tools · Games · Hardware · Data projects · Automations · Agents · Interactive experiences

## What we ask every team to do

01
**Solve something real.**
Start with a problem or moment you actually understand.

02
**Make something that works.**
A rough demo that runs beats a perfect slide deck.

03
**Try something bold.**
Take a swing. Judges notice ambition.

04
**Know what you built.**
Explain how it works, why it matters, and what's next.

WHO WILL BE IN THE ROOM

# Judges and organizers.



**Dominic Saunders**
**Judge · Tesla**
Campion College · Princeton



**Jordan Howell**
**Judge · Microsoft**
Campion College · Kettering



**Joshua Ardito**
**Judge · Meta**
Campion College · Carnegie Mellon



**Tahj Atkinson**
**Judge · Google**
Campion College · Illinois Tech



**Kendall Todd**
**Judge · Accenture**
Hillel Academy · UF



**Netania Mundell**
**Judge · Diageo**
St. Andrew High School for Girls · UWI · NYU



**Sheneska Williams**
**Judge · HashiCorp (Terraform)**
Immaculate Conception High School · USF

ORGANIZERS



**Nadani Dixon**
**Organizer · Redfin**
Campion College · Middlebury · Georgia Tech



**Stefen Ewers**
**Organizer · Georgia Tech**
Campion College · Hillel Academy · Georgia Tech

Organisations are each person's employer, listed for context. They are not event sponsors unless stated.

**Confirmed schools: Campion College, Hillel Academy**

CONFIRMED SPONSORS

P237 Labs · organizing partner

Lev Beauty

Vault Motors

Norus Technologies

Frankies

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HOW WORK IS JUDGED

# How the judges decide.

Each team demonstrates its project to the judges. These are the lenses they use, in plain language. There are no point values.

**Problem & Insight**
Did you find something worth fixing, and do you get why it matters?

**Product & Solution**
Does your idea actually answer the problem?

**Execution**
Does it work? How much did you really build today?

**Originality**
Is it fresh, or a new take on something familiar?

**Impact**
Who would this help, and how much?

**Pitch & Demo**
Can you show it and explain it clearly?

**Complexity alone does not win Hack 876.**

## Prizes

| | |
|---|---|
| **Hack 876 Winner** | iPad per student (up to 4) |
| **Second Place** | AirPods Pro per student (up to 4) |
| **Third Place** | US$150 gift card per student (up to 4) |
| **Best Design** | US$50 gift card per student (up to 4) |
| **Boldest Idea** | US$200 team project grant |
| **People's Choice** | US$50 gift card per student (up to 4) |

**Prizes are tentative and subject to change.**

**Prizes are a bonus; the experience of building is the point.**

No. Hack 876 does not offer or promise internships, jobs, scholarships, interviews or placements.

SAFETY, SUPERVISION AND COST

# What families and the school can rely on.

**Supervision**
Students are supervised by Hack 876 staff and volunteers for the whole day, at the Spanish Court Hotel.

**One day**
It is not overnight. Hack 876 runs for a single day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM, and every student goes home that evening.

**Access and medical needs**
Tell the organizers as early as possible, at info@hack876.com, so arrangements can be made with the venue.

**AI tools**
Students use only organizer-approved, age-appropriate tools. Students under 18 will not use adults-only tools at Hack 876, with or without permission.

**Consent**
Every participant needs a consent form signed by a parent or guardian. This applies whatever the student's age.

**Food**
Food is provided on the day, and the schedule includes a lunch break. Accepted students will be asked about allergies and dietary needs in advance.

**Emergencies**
Every family will be given an on-site contact and the emergency procedure before the event.

**Conduct**
The Code of Conduct and Event Rules are at www.hack876.com/code-of-conduct and www.hack876.com/rules.

## Not provided

**Transport:** No transport has been arranged, so families should plan to bring students to the Spanish Court Hotel for 8:00 AM and collect them at 7:30 PM.

**Devices:** Every student needs to bring their own laptop or other device to build on, plus a charger. Hack 876 is not providing laptops or other hardware.

## Cost

**Hack 876 is free. There is no fee for the school or for students.**

## Being finalised, shared with families before the event

- **Supervision:** The number of supervising adults and the written safeguarding procedures.
- **On-site contact:** The on-site contact details.
- **AI tools:** Which tools are approved, and the age limit for each.
- **Consent form:** The exact wording of the form and how it is returned.
- **Arrival and collection:** Drop-off and pick-up procedures, and whether any transport will be arranged.
- **Food:** The menu.

NEXT STEPS

# What we ask of AISK.

- Confirm AISK's participation by email to info@hack876.com.
- Name a member of staff as our contact.
- Share the opportunity with eligible students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form (Grades 11 and 12 at AISK), and recommend those who would enjoy it.
- Advise us on school permissions and on communication with parents.

**AISK is not asked to pay, host, organize, transport or supervise anything.**

For planning, we have roughly 8 to 12 AISK students in mind: an estimate, not a quota or a promise.

| | |
|---|---|
| **First** | An email to info@hack876.com confirming AISK's participation and naming a staff contact. |
| **If AISK agrees** | Support in principle, and a school-side contact. |
| **Then** | Teachers share the opportunity, and Grade 11 and 12 students apply. |
| **Before the event** | Accepted students and their families receive consent forms. |
| **Event day** | Hack 876, Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative). |

## Email info@hack876.com to confirm AISK's participation

We wrote to you by email on 16 October 2026 and would be glad to hear from you.

**Stefen Ewers and Nadani Dixon, co-organizers · info@hack876.com**

Prefer to talk first? Book 15 minutes: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

## AISK's vision is that its students shape the future.

Let's give a few Hurricanes one day to build it.

**Hack 876**

**www.hack876.com**

**The AISK page**

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